← Back

# Check Your Understanding: Generalized Anxiety Disorder

Practice Assignment • 5 min

Due Sep 9, 11:59 PM IST

## Your grade: 100%

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Next item →

Instructions

1. **Which of the following is an accurate reflection of the diagnostic criteria for GAD?** 1 / 1 point

○ People with GAD typically focus their anxiety on a single topic, such as work stress.
○ Individuals with GAD can control their levels of worry but typically choose not to do so.
● Typically individuals with GAD worry about many different topics instead of focusing on a single one.
○ The diagnostic criteria for GAD require a person to have experienced symptoms for a minimum of 1 month.

**Nice work**

In GAD, a person's worrying is not focused on a single topic, but rather generalized so that it floats from topic to topic, often being attached to whatever the person is focusing on. This worry is uncontrollable and must have been present for at least 6 months prior to a diagnosis.

2. **Which of the following describes the experience of GAD?** 1 / 1 point

● The anxiety and worry experienced with GAD cause substantial difficulty in people's lives.
○ People with GAD typically have anxiety that is about as intense as people without GAD, but people with GAD worry more frequently.
○ Most people with GAD experience excessive worrying without any other symptoms.
○ Coping strategies such as deep breathing or counting to ten are typically effective ways of combating the anxiety present in GAD.

**Nice work**

A diagnosis of GAD, like that of any other psychological disorder, requires that the symptoms lead to an impairment in functioning.

3. **In the overall population, the lifetime prevalence rate for GAD is** 1 / 1 point

○ over 50%.
○ approximately 0.5%.
○ between 20% and 25%.
● between 2% and 7%.

**Nice work**

The lifetime prevalence rate for GAD (the percentage of the population that have had GAD at some point in their life), is about 4.3%. Twelve-month prevalence rates (the percentage of the population that have had GAD in the past year) are significantly lower. Both statistics depend on the age of the individual (middle-aged people show the highest rates of GAD) and gender (women have higher rates than men).

4. **Which of the following best explains how race/ethnicity and household income can play a role in the development of anxiety disorders?** 1 / 1 point

○ In the United States, people of color tend to face fewer life stressors than White Americans and are therefore less likely to develop GAD.
○ People of color often choose not to use the mental health resources that are available to them, leading to higher rates of GAD.
● Factors such as discrimination and poverty increase stress, which increases anxiety, which leads to higher rates of GAD.
○ People of color tend to have weaker family bonds than Whites, leading to greater stress and higher rates of GAD.

**Nice work**

Stress is an important cause of anxiety. To the extent that members of non-majority groups (people of color, LGBTQ people, people living in poverty) experience greater stress (including stress due to discrimination), they are more likely to develop anxiety disorders.

5. **Which of the following statements concerning the biological influences on GAD is accurate?** 1 / 1 point

○ GAD appears to be determined entirely by environmental factors such as socioeconomic status.
○ Evidence suggests that biological predispositions such as genetics are the most important factor in determining whether a person develops GAD.
● GAD is associated with activity in parts of the brain associated with learning to fear stimuli.
○ Researchers have an understanding of all of the biological factors that underlie GAD.

**Nice work**

Brain areas that are involved in learning to fear stimuli show more activation in people with GAD, suggesting an important role for learning in GAD development. Genetics and environmental factors both play vital roles in the development of GAD. Further, epigenetics shows that genetics and the environment combine in complicated ways to influence GAD. Therefore, it's not possible to label one as being more important than the other.

**See feedback**

After you submit this assignment click "See feedback" to see how you did, along with helpful information that will reinforce the lesson concepts.